



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: True North Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.tnclassical.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

True North Classical Academy Florida (Miami-Dade area, 33173) shows a clear and robust Classical education orientation across most rubric categories, anchored in the liberal arts tradition, Great Books emphasis, and the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric). Public materials repeatedly emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty, virtue and character formation, a mastery-focused curriculum, and a pedagogy that blends memorization and chant in early grades with Socratic discussion and rhetoric in higher grades. The school presents a strong faculty culture (described as living curriculum and mission-driven), and a collaborative, parent-inclusive community model (parents as co-participants in fundraising and open-campus engagement). While explicit mentions of formal theology, liturgical practice, or organized worship are not pervasive in the public materials, the transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) and explicit classical pedagogy are prominent, supporting a classification of CLASSICAL with minor caveats in Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations).

Key signals from public materials include:

- The Great Books framework, grammar-logic-rhetoric progression, and emphasis on the Great Conversation (Classical core).
- Clear statements about formation, virtue, character, and pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty.
- Pedagogy that includes singing/chanting in the grammar stage and Socratic/seminar/rhetoric in the upper grades.
- Faculty as the heartbeat of the school and a living curriculum, with explicit emphasis on teacher training in classical methods.
- Strong parent/community partnership, fundraising structures, and opportunities for parent involvement and campus visits.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Note: Some of Element 1 evidence reflects a strong transcendental and moral orientation without explicit public theology or liturgical practice in the materials reviewed. This yields a nuanced but still CLASSICAL classification for Element 1, with the other five categories meeting Classical criteria more fully.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty and virtue as intrinsic aims of education (e.g., statements about the classical ideal and moral formation). See text describing the school's classical ideal and virtue-oriented aims.

- Documentation mentions a moral/character focus and reverence for timeless principles and virtue, aligning with transcendental aims.
- Explicit theological or liturgical practices are not prominently described in public materials; philosophy is framed around classical virtue and moral realism rather than explicit liturgical life.
- Positive keyword analysis (from the Six Essential Elements lexicon)
- Present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wonder, chant
- Absent or not explicit: theology, liturgy, sacred, creed, doxology, worship, Mass
- Source for keyword lists: classicality_lexicon.v2.2.txt (Positive signals for Element 1)
- Evidence of presence in school materials: “pursuit of the True, Good, and Beautiful”; virtue; chanting; wonder in curriculum; culture statements; Great Books emphasis. Sample citations: “pursuit of the True, Good, and Beautiful.”; “virtue”; “chanting” in grammar stage.
- Why this rating
- The school centers on transcendental ideals (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue formation, but explicit theology, liturgy, or sacramental practices are not clearly foregrounded in public materials. That yields a strong but not fully explicit religious/metaphysical alignment, thus SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission statements emphasize formation of virtue and wisdom, excellence of soul/mind/body, and character formation over mere information or job preparation. “Our purpose is to create scholars that exemplify the classical ideal – excellence in soul, mind, and body.”
- Public materials describe pursuing Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as a telos, with formation and human excellence at the center of education.
- Statements about formation, character, and lifelong love of learning indicate a formation-centric aim rather than purely job-readiness.
- Positive keyword analysis
- Present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, liberal education/paideia, classical mission, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, contemplation/rest (scholé), great conversation (inferred via Great Books framework)
- Negative keywords: none prominent in public materials (no explicit emphasis on workforce prep or job-readiness as primary telos)
- Lexicon reference for positive signals: Six Elements lexicon; “formation,” “liberal education/paideia,” “telos,” “great conversation,” “pursuit of the true, good, beautiful.”
- Evidentiary anchors from TN materials: formation-focused language, virtue-centered aims, and the telos of Truth/Good/Beauty.
- Why this rating
- Across mission, vision, and curricular framing, the school foregrounds virtue, formation, and the classical telos, aligning well with Classical expectations for Element 2.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Explicit articulation of grammar, logic, and rhetoric as the liberal arts backbone (the Trivium). Materials describe “grammar, logic, and rhetoric” as the three stages of learning.
- Emphasis on Great Books and the Great Conversation (public materials reference Great Books as core content and the aim to engage with perennial texts).
- History is treated as a throughline in the curriculum (Western civilization/traditions) rather than a narrow “social studies” approach; the Great Books cycle and Western thought framing support this.
- Evidence of memory/recitation and chant in early grades (a traditional feature of classical curricula). Grammar stage includes chanting historical figures/events and poetry.
- Positive keyword analysis

- Present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; great conversation; history (via Western civilization framing); memory work; chant.
- Negative keywords: not present as dominant features (no strong emphasis on project-based learning replacing classical text engagement; not all content explicitly labeled “social studies” as a core).
- Lexicon reference for positive signals: Element 3 keywords include liberal arts, trivium, grammar/logic/rhetoric, great books, history, great conversation, etc.
- Evidentiary anchors: Great Books and Great Conversation language; grammar/logic/rhetoric; chanting/memory in early grades.
- Why this rating
- The curricular architecture aligns strongly with classical education as defined by the lexicon: Trivium, Great Books, and cross-subject engagement with timeless content are central.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Upper-school pedagogy features Socratic discussions, seminars, and debates, with explicit rhetoric training and opportunities for public speaking. The rhetoric-focused capstone / oration framework is described.
- The grammar stage emphasizes memory work, recitation, and chanting; lower-school activities include singing/chanting to reinforce learning and memory.
- Teaching at True North describes direct instruction in the grammar stage and advancement to the Socratic method in the logic stage, culminating in rhetoric-stage authorship and original classics.
- The school explicitly notes training in classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, etc.) with recognized curricular professionals.
- Positive keyword analysis
- Present: Socratic seminar/discussion, seminars, debates; logic, rhetoric; memory work; chanting; formal public-speaking opportunities.
- Negative keywords: not prominent in public materials (no wholesale emphasis on project-based only or constructivist-only approaches).
- Lexicon reference for positive indicators: Socratic seminars, memory work, chanting, rhetoric, seminars, debates, and scholé/restful elements appear in the lexicon as markers of classical pedagogy.
- Evidentiary anchors: explicit mention of Socratic method progression; grammar-to-logic-to-rhetoric pedagogy; upper-level rhetoric complexity.
- Why this rating
- The teaching methods align with classical pedagogy across grade bands, with a clear progression from memorization/chanting to Socratic discourse and rhetoric.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The faculty is described as a “living curriculum” and the school frames teachers as the heartbeat of the institution, with a focus on elite, world-class teacher preparation and ongoing training in classical methodology.
- There is explicit emphasis on training and equipping teachers with classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, training in philosophy of classical education, and coaching).
- The school lists a cross-disciplinary “great books” oriented faculty persona (e.g., listing historic figures and classical authors in the teacher roster and curricular references).
- Positive keyword analysis
- Present: living curriculum; faculty of friends; elite/world-class faculty; teacher training in classical pedagogy; great books seminars for faculty; model teachers; mentors; portrait of a teacher (implied by the “living curriculum” phrasing and explicit teacher descriptions).
- Negative keywords: none clearly indicated in public materials.
- Lexicon reference: Element 5 keywords emphasize living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, and collegial culture; the school material aligns with these signals.

- Evidentiary anchors: direct statements about faculty as the heartbeat and training in classical pedagogy.
- Why this rating
- The materials depict a highly intentional and professional faculty culture, continuous training, and a “living curriculum,” consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school presents a strong partnership with parents, with fundraising, a Community Investment Fund, and emphasis on parental involvement as a critical part of sustaining a classical program. “The power of hundreds of True North parents, grandparents, and friends joining their generous gifts together helps us...” and similar lines emphasize parent/community partnership.
- Public materials describe parent involvement in supporting the school’s operation and mission (Community Investment Fund, donor-based funding, and transparency about tax-deductible contributions).
- Information about campus choice and enrollment emphasizes open access and information sessions; campuses host information sessions and open houses, indicating ongoing parent engagement and visibility.
- Positive keyword analysis
- Present: partnership with parents; co-teachers (language used in classical lexicon); parent formation (book groups, seminars); open campus/visits; community investment/fundraising; parent involvement and meetings; family engagement.
- Negative keywords: none prominently present in public materials.
- Lexicon reference for positive signals: Element 6 keywords emphasize parent partnership, co-teachers, parent formation, open campus, and hospitable community engagement.
- Evidentiary anchors: statements about parent involvement in fundraising; explicit language about open sessions and campus tours; the emphasis on families supporting the school’s mission.
- Why this rating
- The materials illustrate a robust, explicit partnership with parents and community, aligned with CLASSICAL expectations for Element 6.

Overall assessment across categories

- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

- Element 1 would move toward a fuller CLASSICAL if explicit theological grounding and liturgical/community worship practices were foregrounded alongside the current transcendental/virtue emphasis. This could include explicit statements about theology integration across disciplines, liturgical practices, or chapel/worship elements that clearly connect the classical curriculum to a religious/metaphysical framework beyond virtue and moral realism.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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